

Arkady Kukin. 2026

Portfolio

General

Game designer and interactive artist. I work with all kinds of games, from dance rituals to therapeutic video games.
I bring to art the experience of mindful and tactile interaction and playful pretending

Education

- NUST MISIS
  Master's Degree — ArtTECH
  2025–2027
- Higher School of Economics (HSE), Art and Design School
  Bachelor — Gamedesign and virtual reality
  2022–2025

Contacts

Email: kukin.arkady@gmail.com
Telegram: https://t.me/BlackComputing



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Exhibitions

2026
- Redhills Gallery — Tomorrow and the Day After Tomorrow

2025
- Ekaterina Cultural Foundation — The Great Disorder
- Omelchenko Gallery — RESPAWN PROTOCOL
- Shtubnits and St. Petersburg Media Art — Digital Rain
- Guide for Complete Dying
- HSE ART AND DESIGN — Game Future
- Yandex.Museum — Games and Technologies

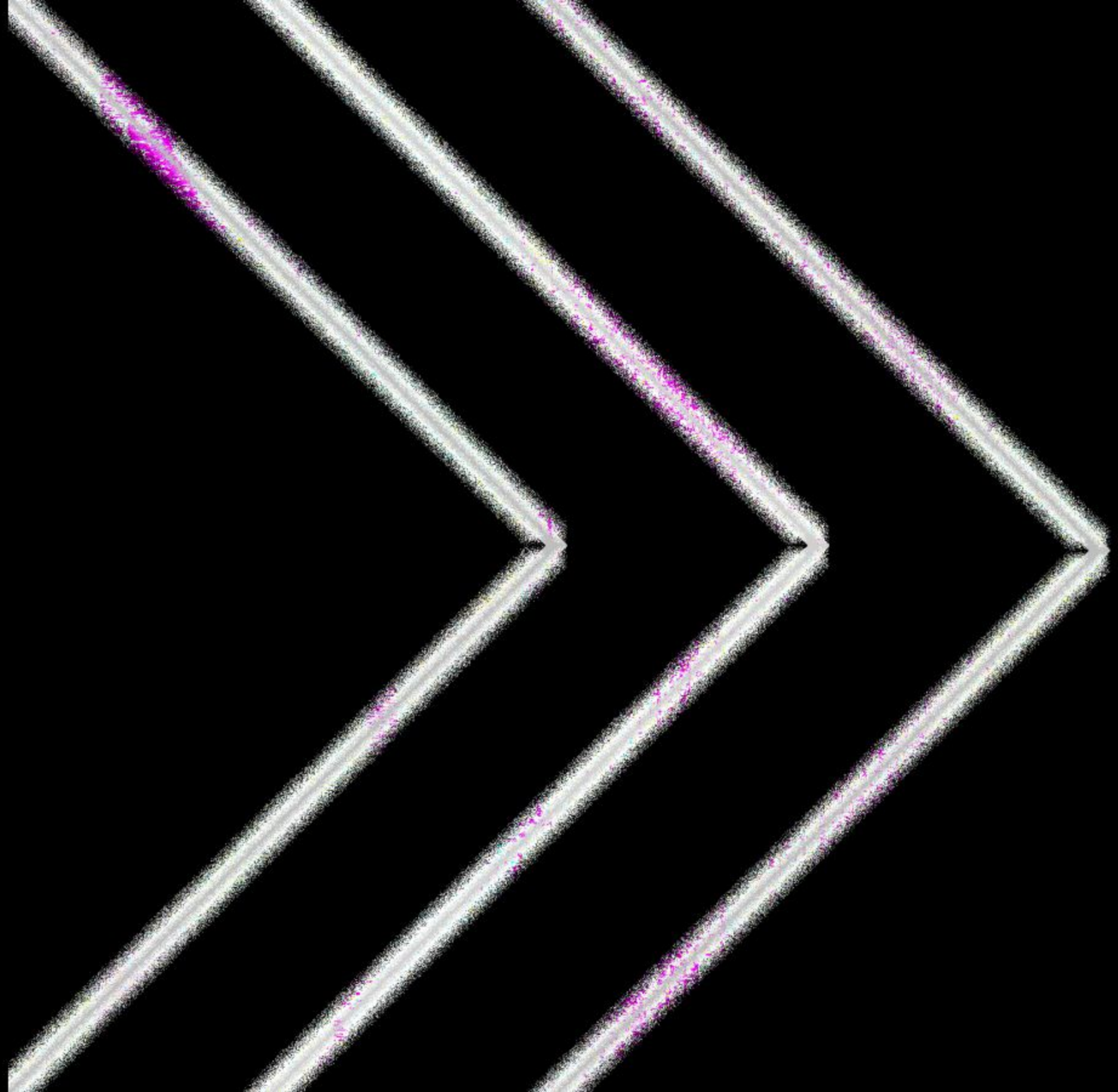
2024
- MMOMA — NII Filaretova. Lucid Dream.
- CCI "Fabrika" — Preventing Trees from Standing Still

Publications

- Interaction between Generative art and videogames (In russian)



Installations



Arduino and light

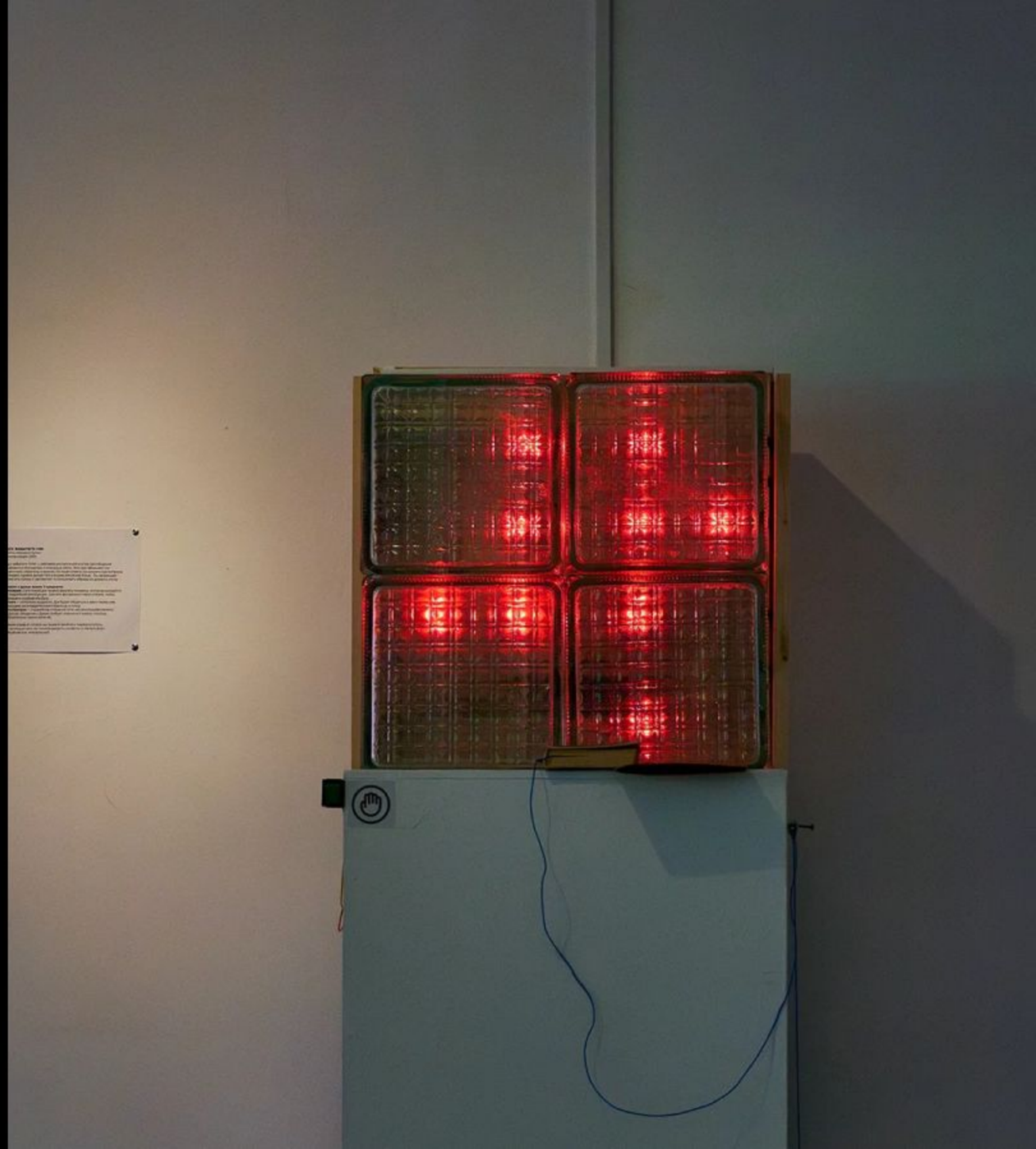
The God of the forgotten RI

Game installation with LED lights, photoresistors and Arduino

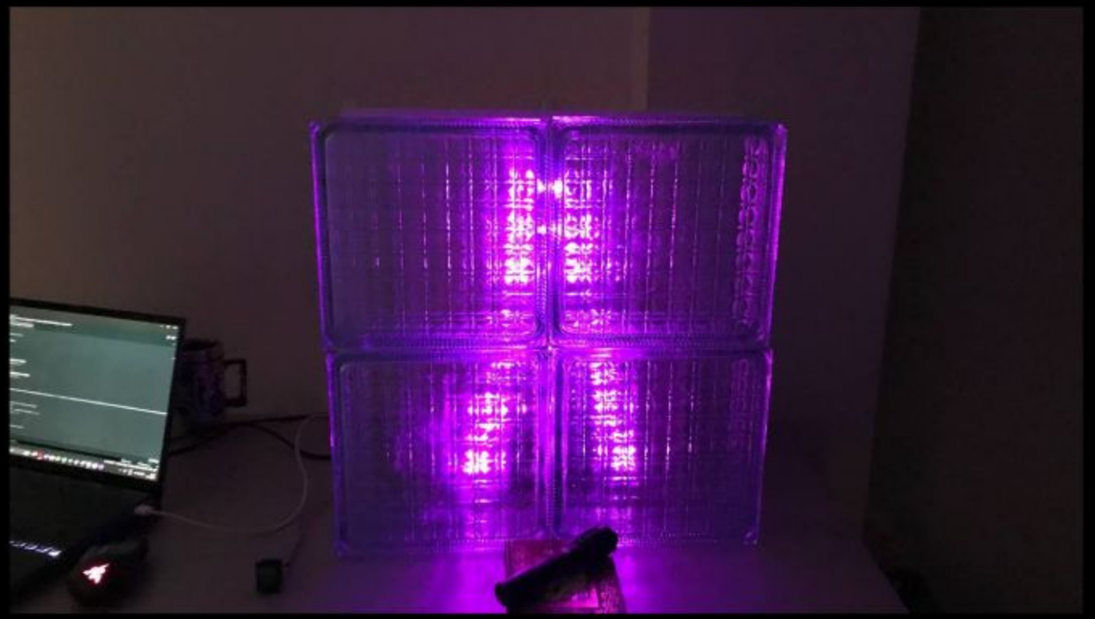
More

Connect wisdom

Arkady Kukin, Timofey Petrenko

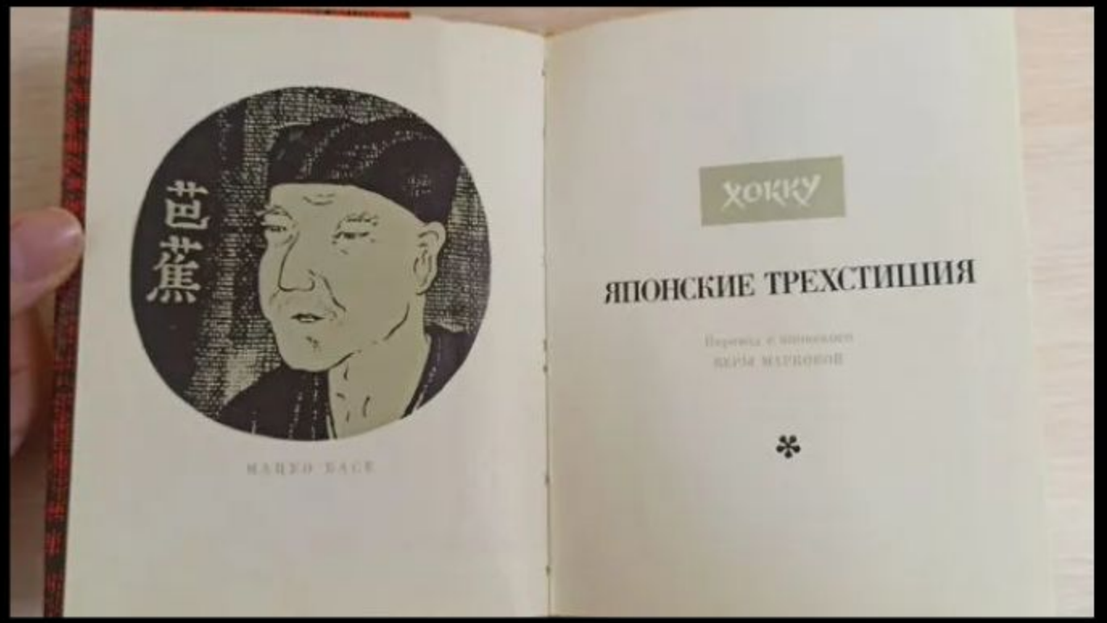


The God of the forgotten RI



Lightart

I was engaged in microcontroller programming and creating a behavior tree system for recognizing player symbols and displaying a literary work.



Books

The installation uses a players mind to connect two books: "400 Questions and Answers on Faith, the Church, and Christian Life" and "Haiku: Japanese Three-Line Verses." The machine asks a question, the person assembles an answer from keywords, and then receives a haiku corresponding to their set of keywords.

Installations · 8

Redhills Gallery — Tomorrow and the Day After Tomorrow

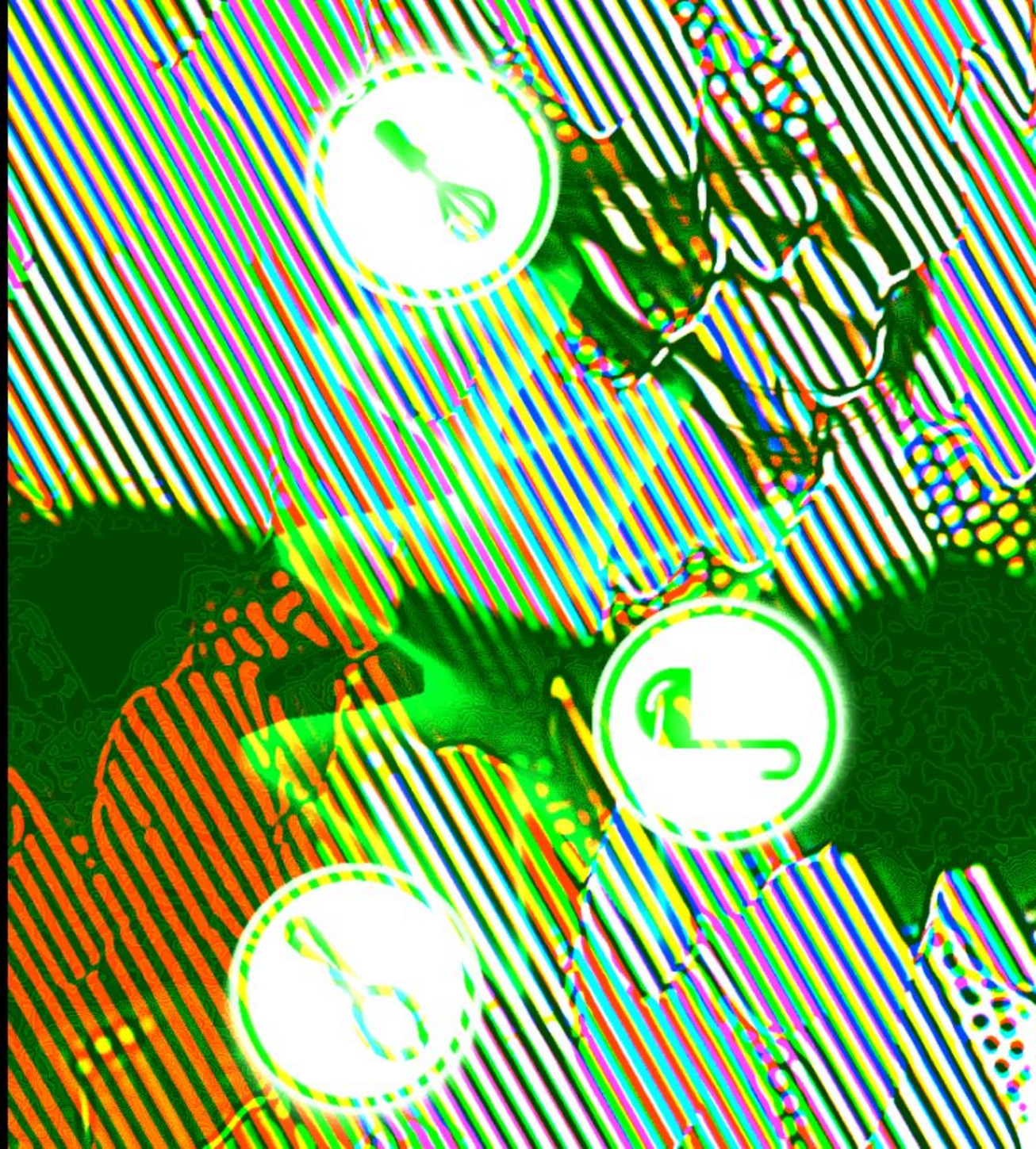
Touchdesigner

Cuisine Collective

Game installation
on Touchdesigner

More

Reconcile the ladles



Cuisine Collective



A Household Tale

Calm and reconcile the relationships between a ladle, a spoon, and a whisk. Move them around the table, bring them together or separate them. The game will help you unravel the complexities and guide you.



System

A camera tracks the positions of the cutlery by color.
Depending on the distance between them, their relationships and moods are calculated:

- Good relationships improve moods when they are brought closer.
- Poor relationships worsen moods when they are brought closer.
- When the cutlery are in a good mood, their relationship improves.

Exhibitions

Mid communication

For Respawn Protocol exhibition

Interactive installation for
Betboom Premium The International

Documentation

Arkady Kukin, Timofey Petrenko, Dmitriy Darvin,
Kristina Yurieva

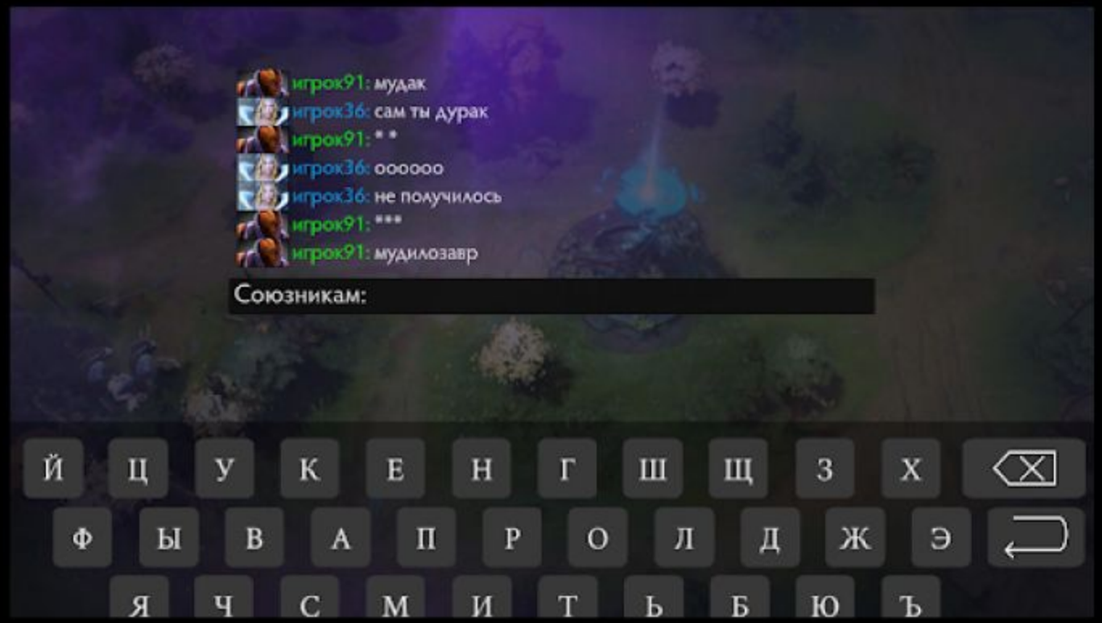


Mid communication



Structure

Project consists of two stands with tablets, each installed with a game. Each stand is designed in the style of characters from Dota 2 and corresponds to a specific in-game role.



Game

The game is a chat: first player must explain a word to the second using only profanity. The second participant, however, can only use ordinary vocabulary. This difference in lexicon encourages the search for new meanings and ways of verbalization.

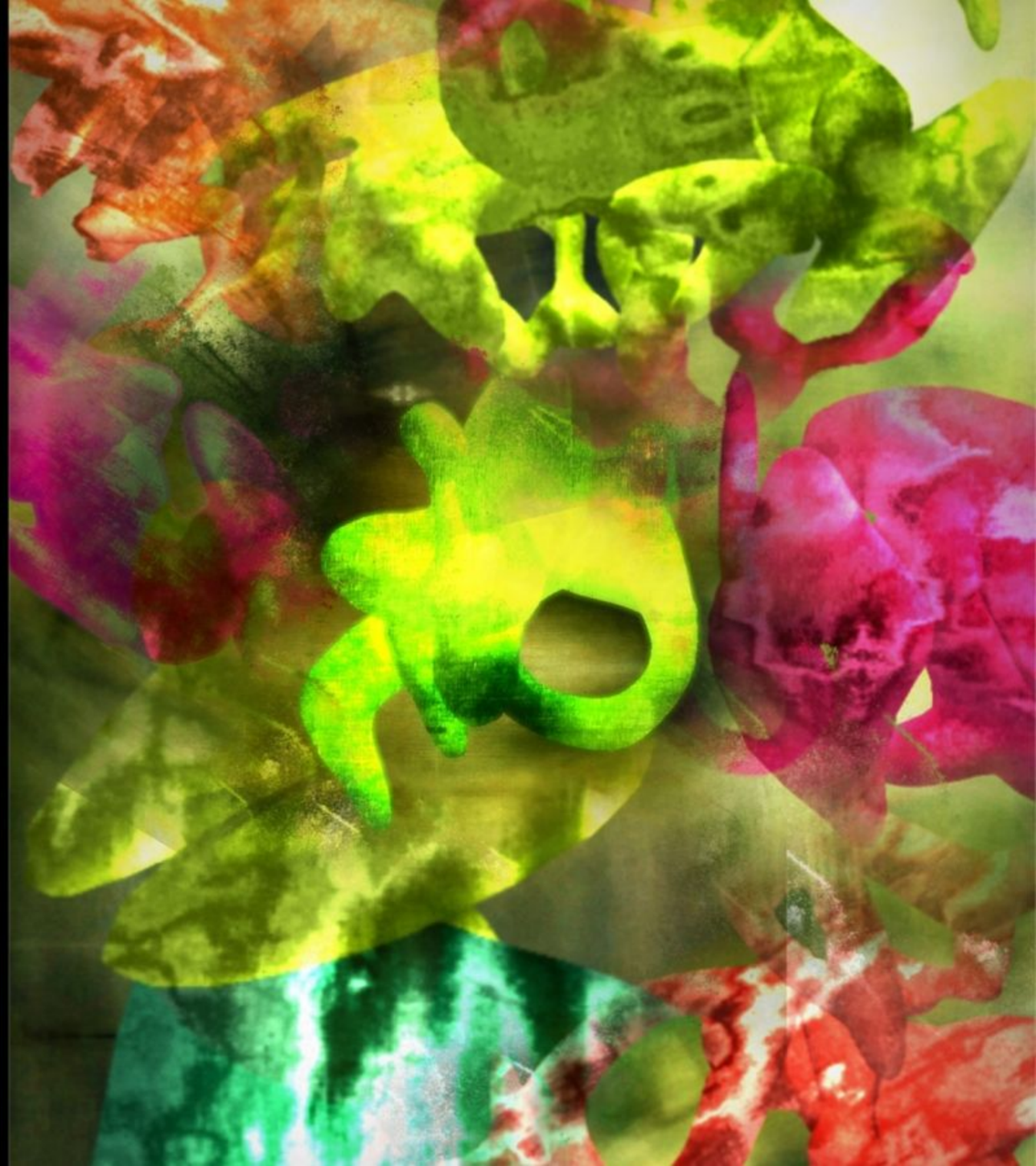
Exhibitions

NII Filaretova.
Lucid Dream.

Play
Exhibition

Total Collaboration in MMOMA

Arkady Kukin, Timofey Petrenko
Alina Antimonova, Ekaterina Izbreht





Magical control

Slowly move your hands in front of the camera to control the figures on the screen.



Collectivity

There is no limit to the number of players. Gather together and combine the figures. Nod, and the result will be photographed.



Performance

Shadows play around you, they will react to the movements of the figures and interact with you.

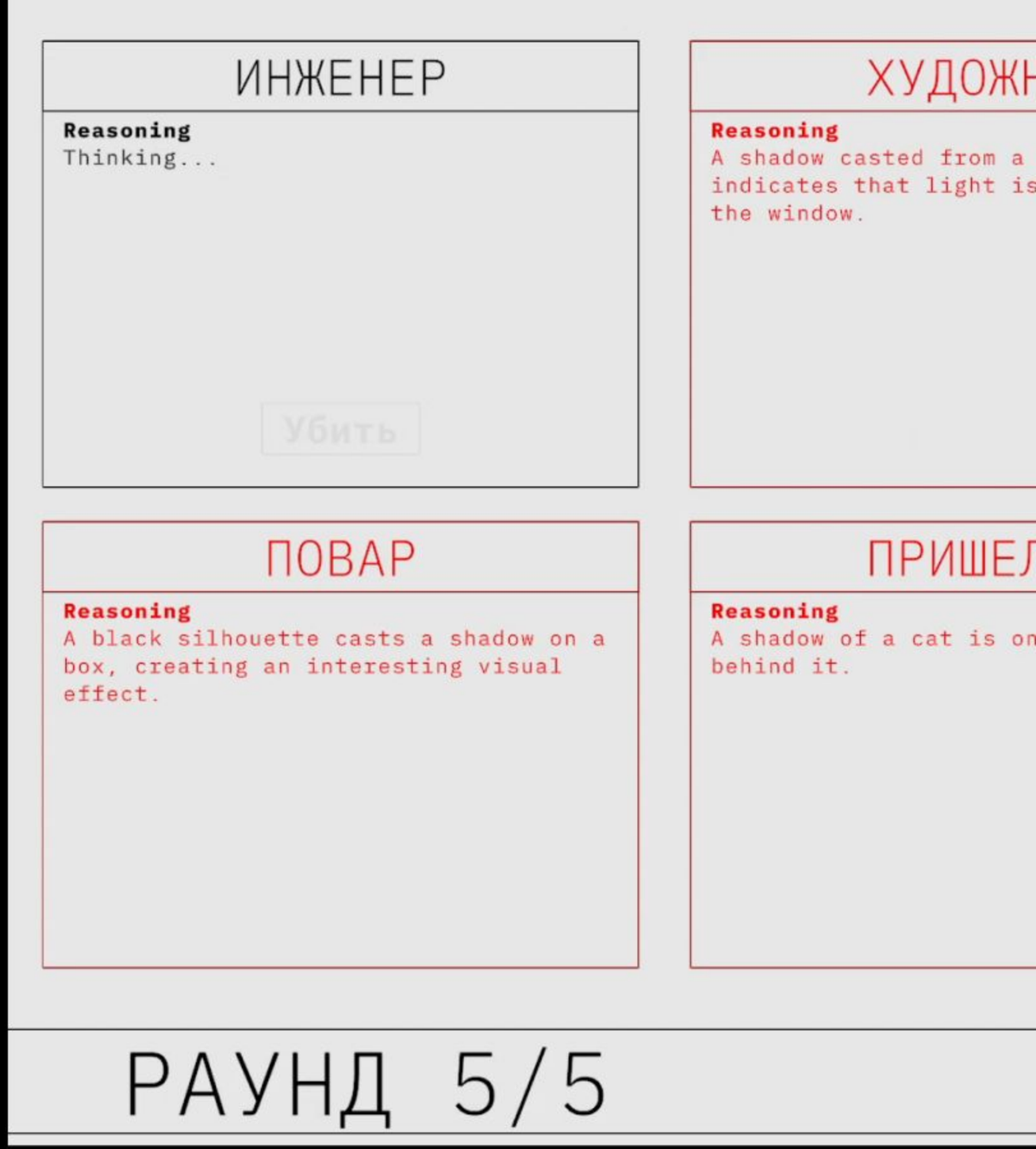
UNITY, PYTHON AND LM STUDIO

Neurocave

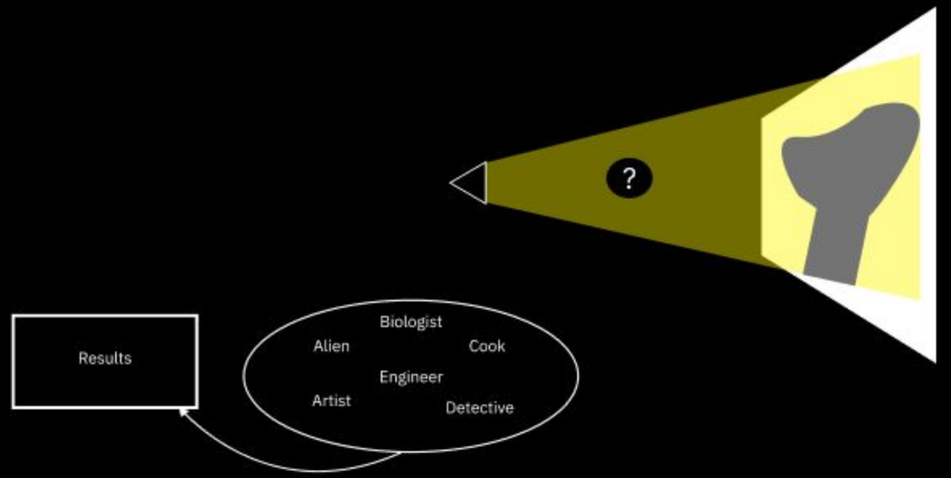
6 AI agents look at the shadow of an object and try to guess it.
You kill them off until you reach the truth.

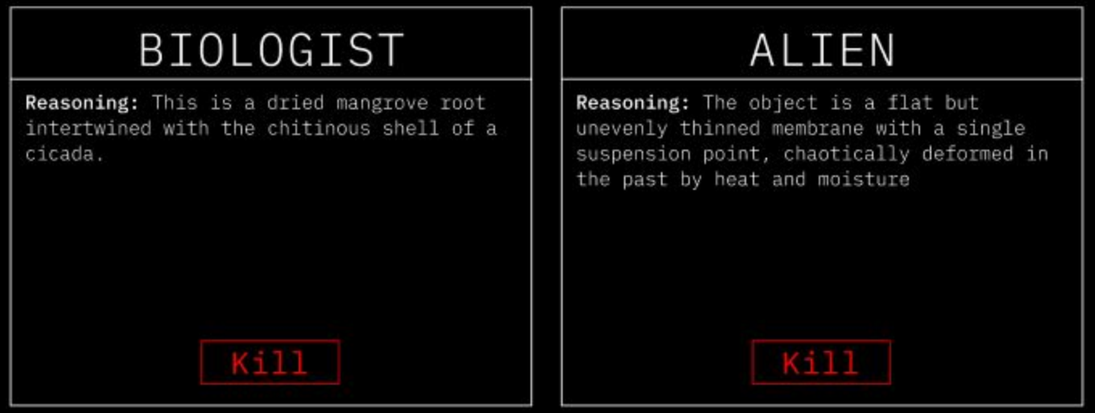
Video

Timofey Petrenko
Arkady Kukin



Neurocave





Plato's cave

We rely on neural networks as sources of truth, but they cannot see the truth — they only have access to its “shadow”. In the installation, an object is hidden from you. But 6 AI characters see its shadow and describe it. Your task is to figure out what is hidden.

Algorithm

The game is divided into rounds, and at the start of each round the characters send you their reasoning.

You choose the one you trust least
and “kill” them, so they stop thinking
and the others don't try to think like them.

And so on until only one is left.

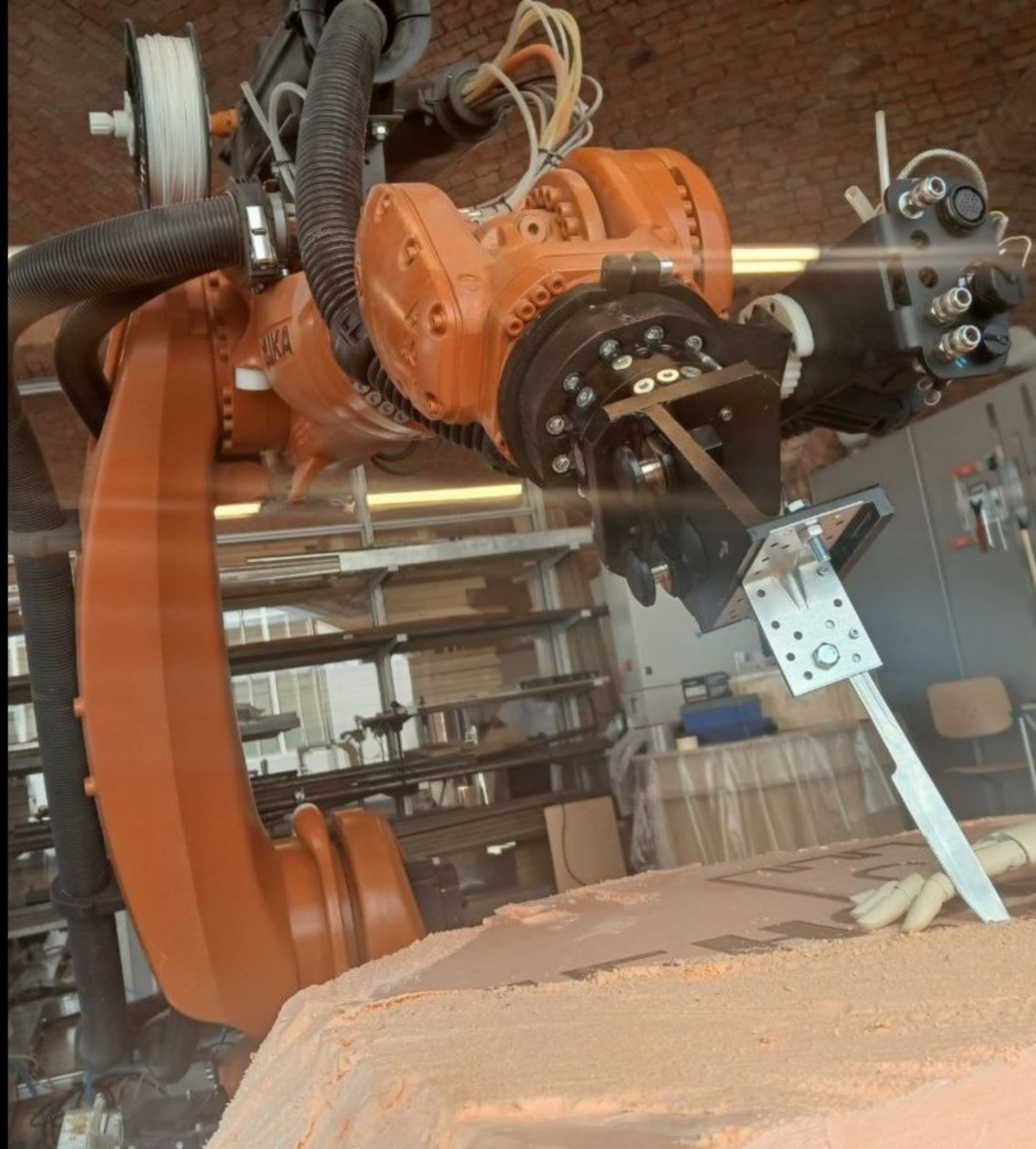
GRASSHOPPER AND ROBOTIC ARM

Perfect Accuracy

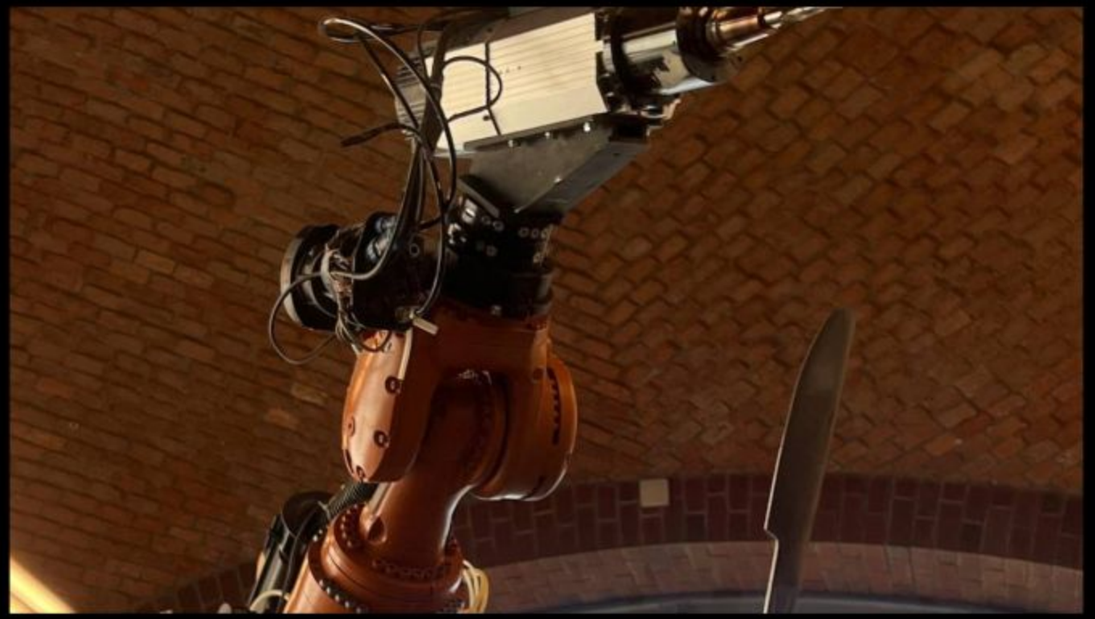
Are you ready to trust your body to technology?

Video

Timofey Petrenko
Arkady Kukin



Perfect Accuracy



Concept

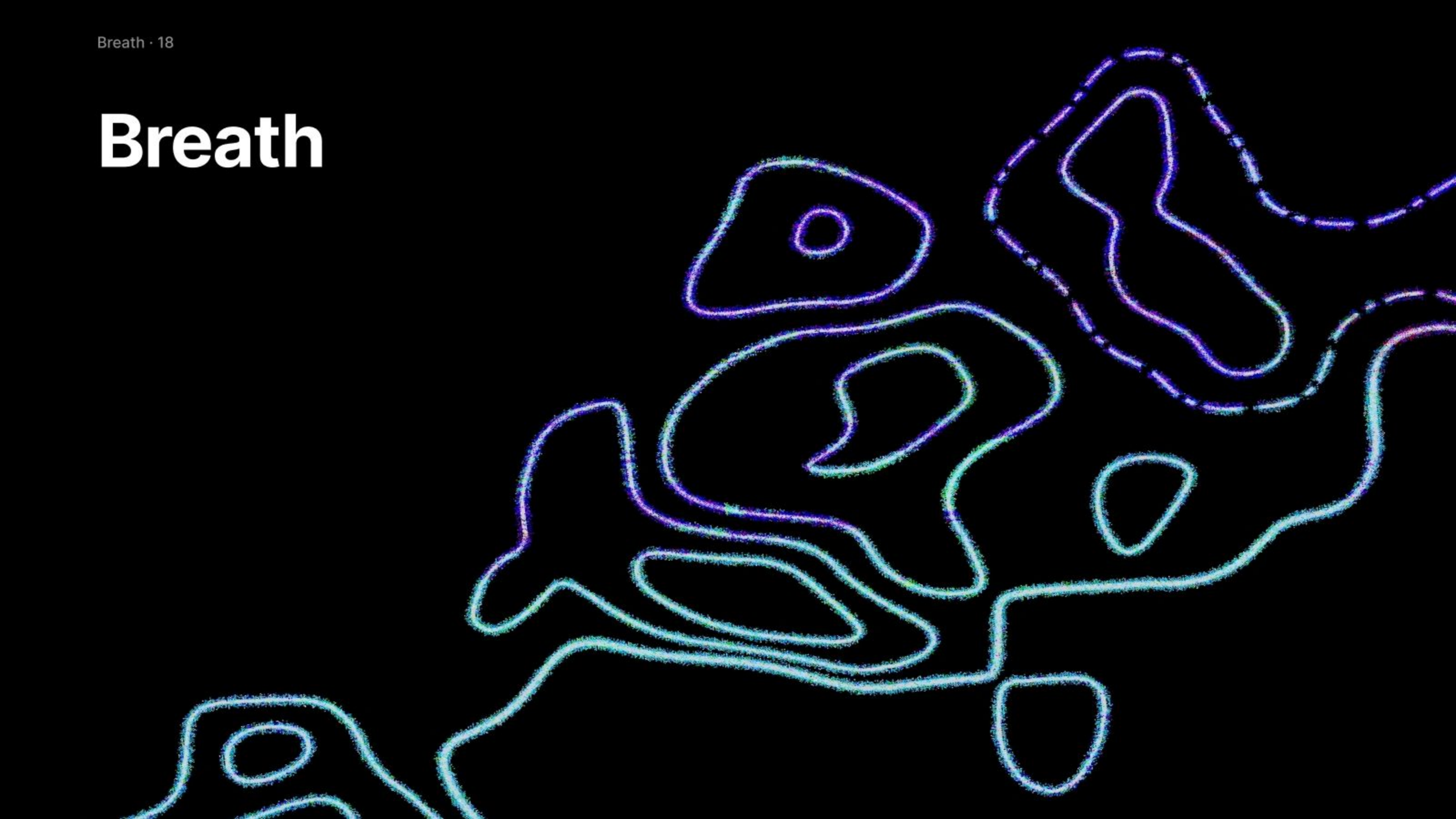
Are you ready to trust your body to technology? If so, you can test your resolve
in the classic game of mumblety-peg. With a robotic arm.



Perfect Accuracy

We created a finger-avoidance algorithm
in Grasshopper and attached a knife
to the robotic arm. For “safety” reasons, we had to use a wooden stand-in for Timofey during filming.

Breath





Lecture

The lecture “Generative Art and Videogames” was dedicated to understanding the “hybridization” of these media



Game

The first playtest of The Ordinate — my new game with innovative controls

PRESSURE SENSOR AND LED

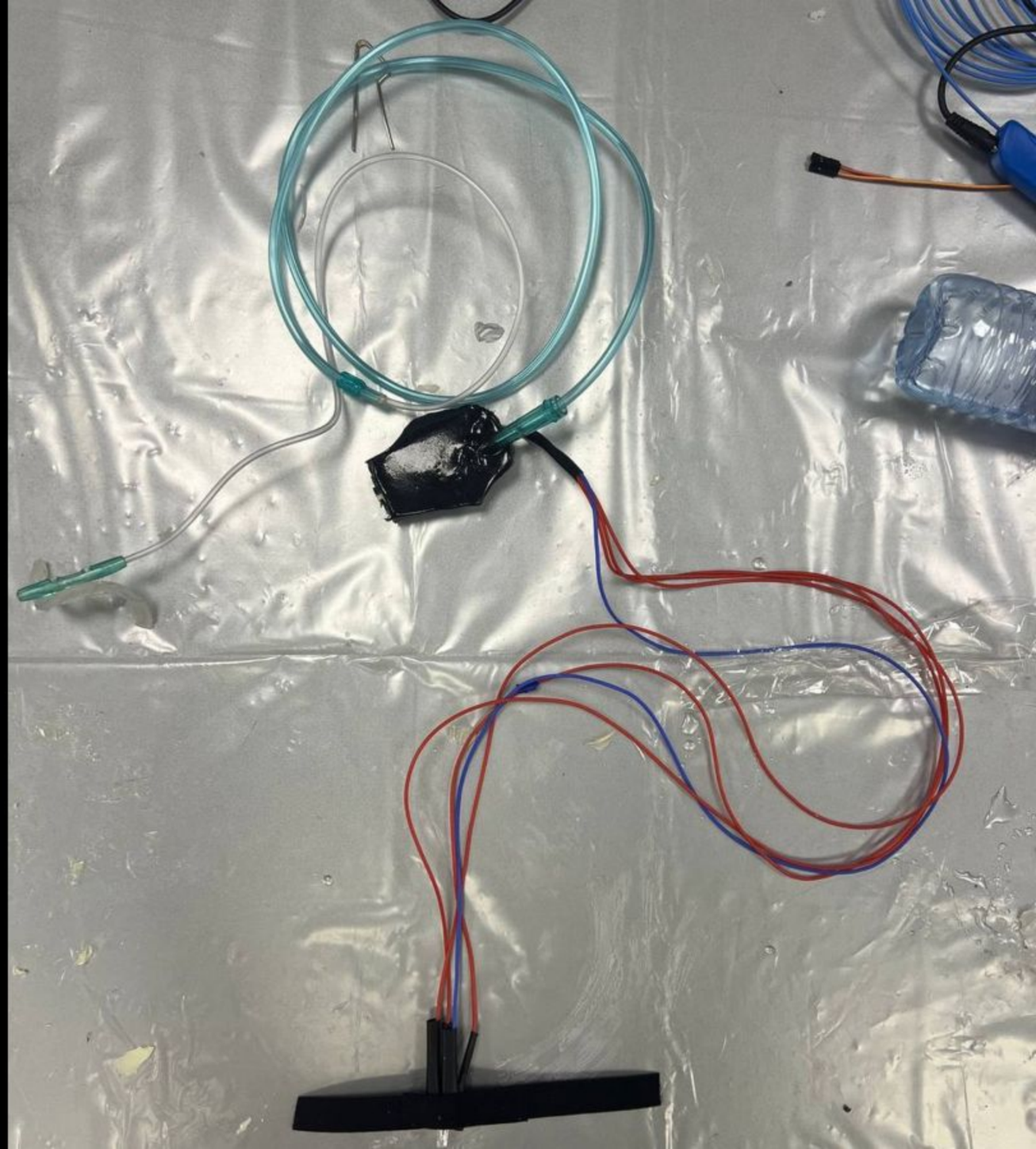
3-4-3

In a stressful situation, it is always hard to regain composure and focus on your breathing.

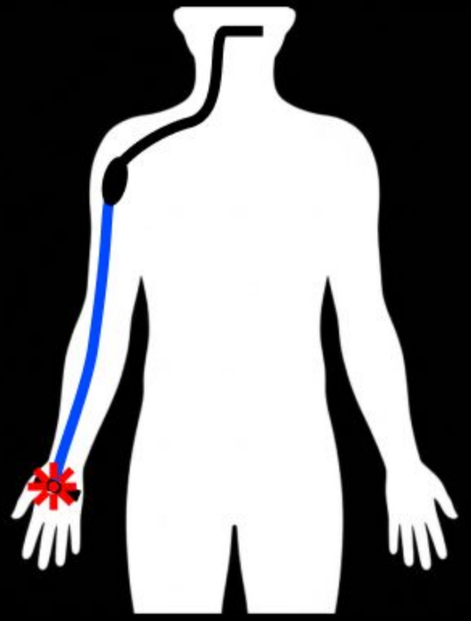
So we made a device that helps you get your bearings at a critical moment

Video

Arkady Kukin, Timofey Petrenko



3-4-3





Always with you

Thanks to the wearable “3-4-3” device, breathing therapy can be with you at any moment! The device monitors your breathing rate and, if your breathing gets disrupted, shows a breathing timer right on your wrist

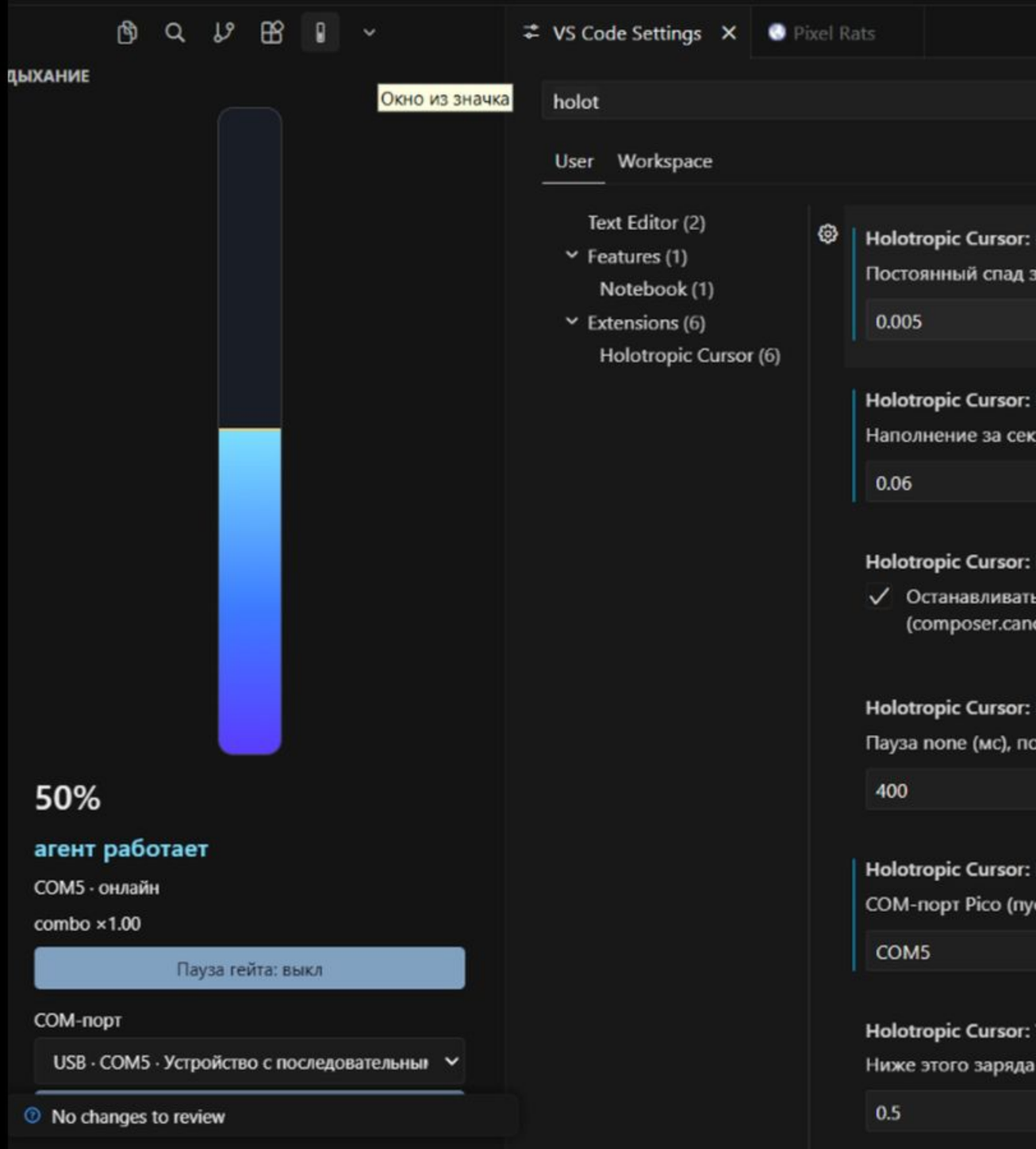
3-4-3

A pressure sensor detects disruptions
in breathing rhythm and uses an LED to show the 3-4-3 rhythm. If the person matches it, the LED turns green

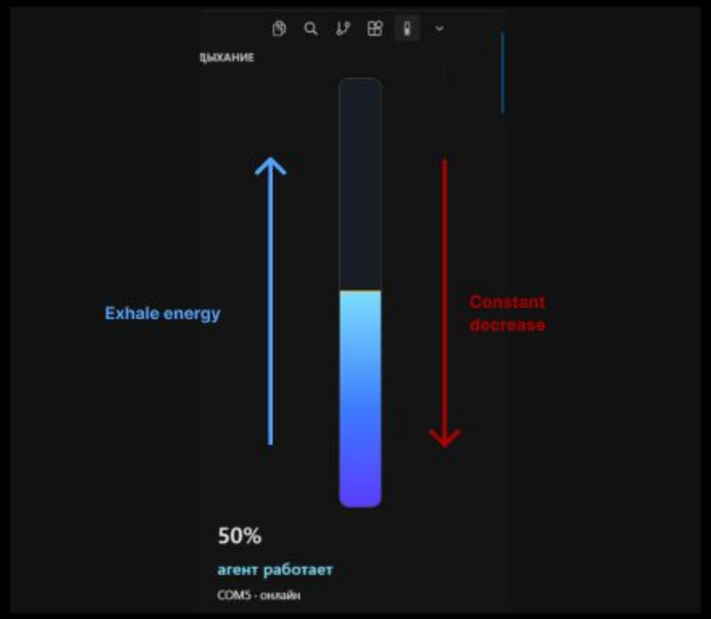
CURSOR PLUGIN AND SENSOR

Holotropic

A Cursor plugin for auto-vibecoding.



Holotropic



Principle

By exhaling, you fill a progress bar. While it stays above 50%, the agent works.



Sensor placement

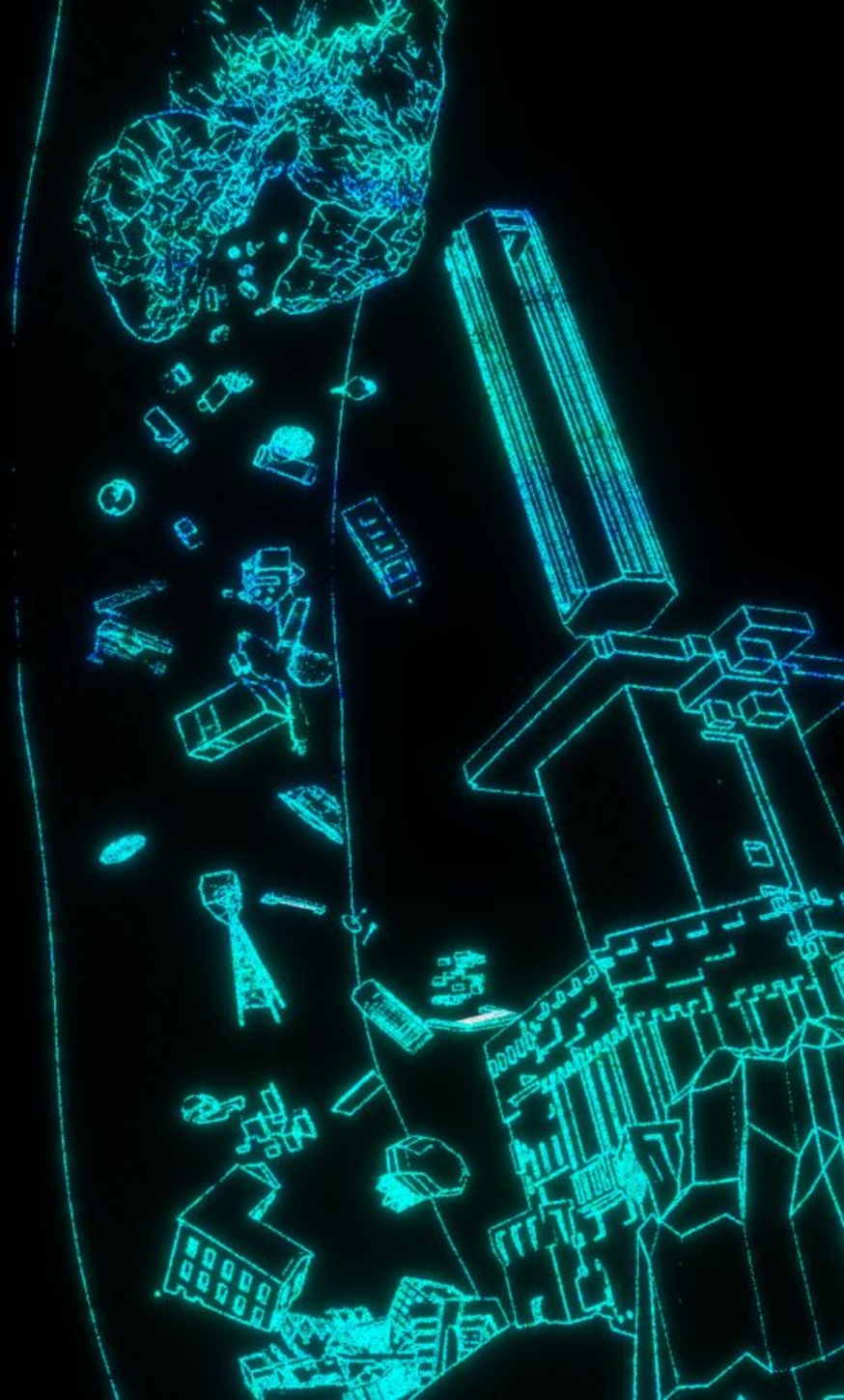
The sensor is attached to glasses and sits under the nose.



Breath

The plugin keeps you in holotropic breathing mode, whose effect is compared to taking hallucinogens.

Videogames and Digital Works



Videogames

- «DirBonSai» (2025)
  A program about cultivating your files through deletion.
- «The Ordinate» (in development)
  An experimental breath-controlled game, being developed as a tool for psychological therapy.
- «NOMAD» (2024)
  A cooperative metaverse project for a student work exhibition.
- «UPADENOK» (2023)
  A zen game about controlling a fall, based on physics and planning.
- «PongU» (2023)
  An ecological version of Pong where trees grow and change the playing field.
- «Untitled Robot Controller» (2023)
  Control a strange robot on another planet with your hands and feet
- «MEM_FRGT» (2023)
  A game that uses LiDAR to visualize the processes of remembering and forgetting.
- «Razvidet» (2022)
  A game exploring auditory and visual perception under noise.



Videogames and Digital Works · 26

Redhills Gallery — Tomorrow and the Day After Tomorrow

DataART

DirBonSai



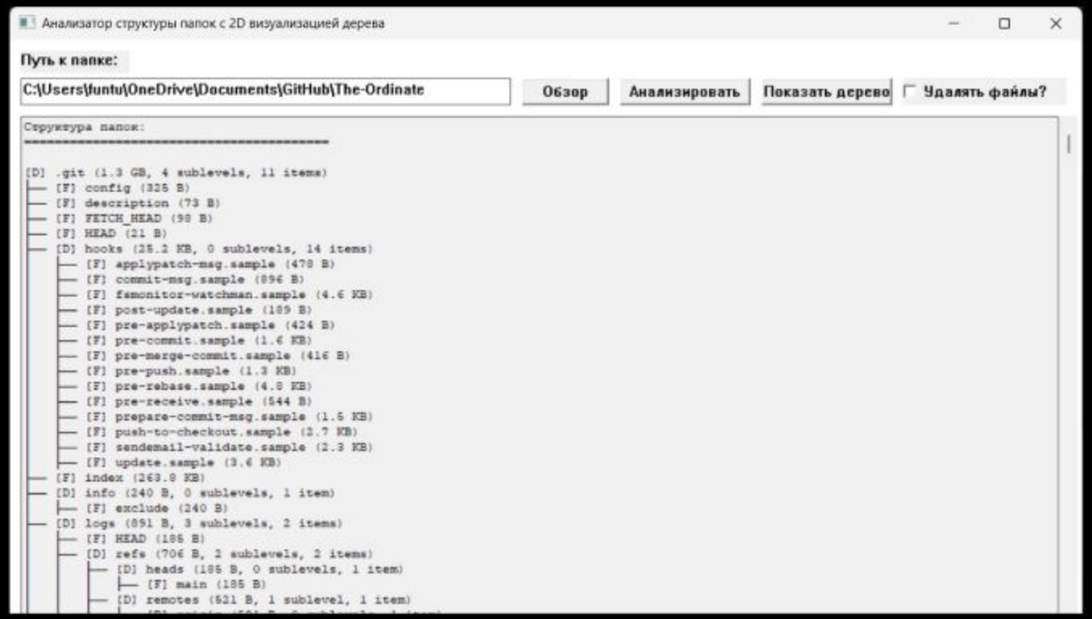
Achieve Zen
around your data

Download

Bonsai and Data-Art

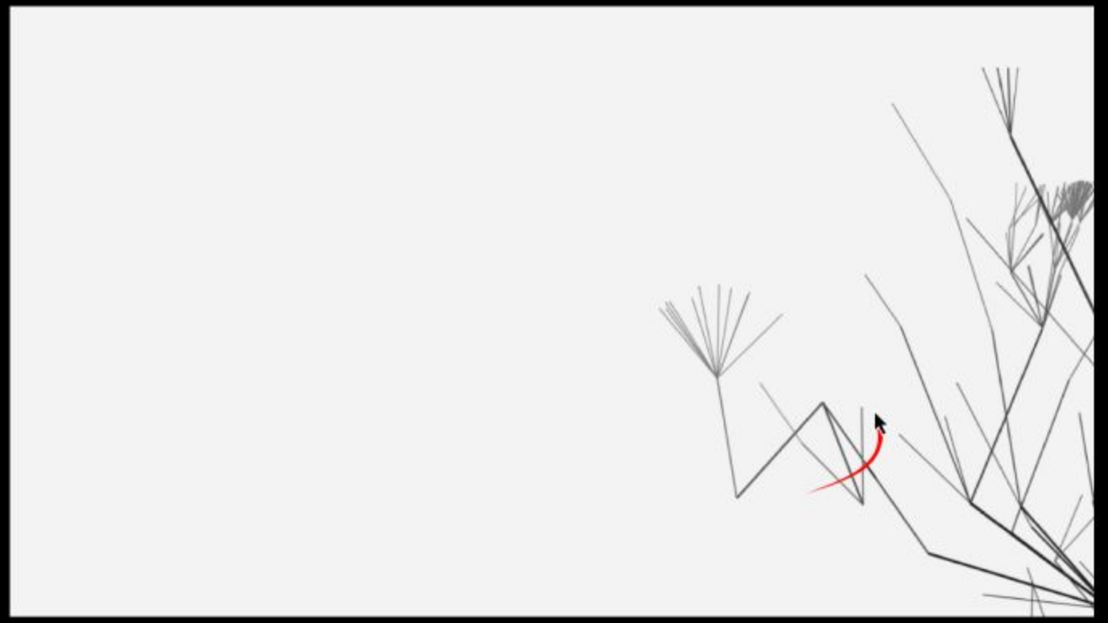
Arkady Kukin, Timofey Petrenko

DirBonSai



Your files

DirBonSai can analyze any folder on your computer. You can choose a work project, a folder of childhood photos, or a random program.



Cultivating beauty

App creates a tree based on your folder structure. You can trim its branches, thereby deleting the corresponding folders.

Videogames

MEM_FRGT

Trailer
Play
Presentation

Record. Analyze. Delete.



MEM_FRGT



LiDAR

You can only see the dots created by your scanner.
You directly perceive the work performed by your visual cortex.

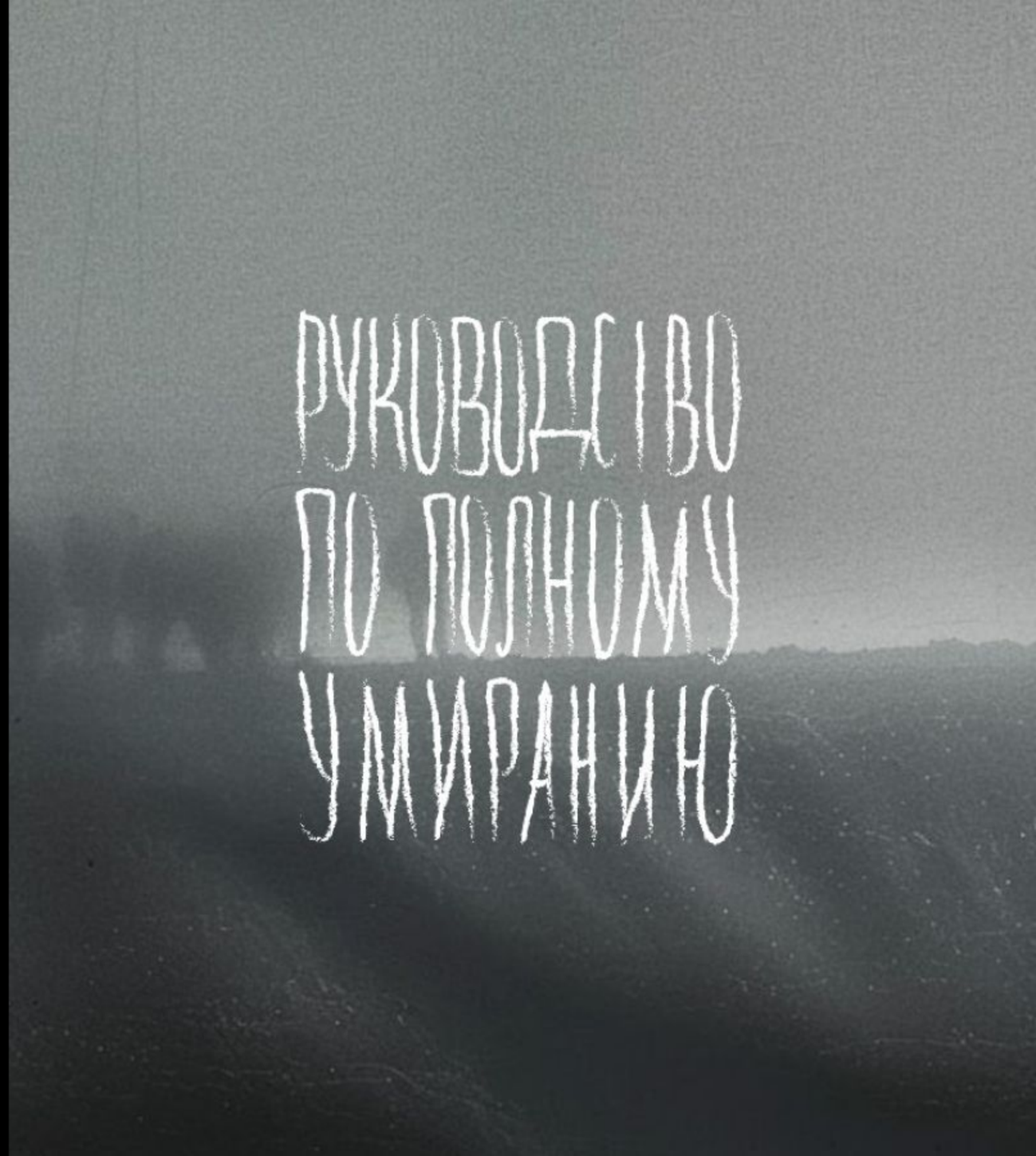


Memory

MEM_FRGT defamiliarizes memory, illustrating how we remember objects, how they become distorted in our memory, and how things out of our attention fade away.

Web-exhibition

Guide for Complete Dying



Play (Archived Version)

Online Exhibitions right for premiere

Arkady Kukin, Timofey Petrenko
Alina Antimonova, Ekaterina Izbreht

Digital works

Shtubnits and St. Petersburg Media Art

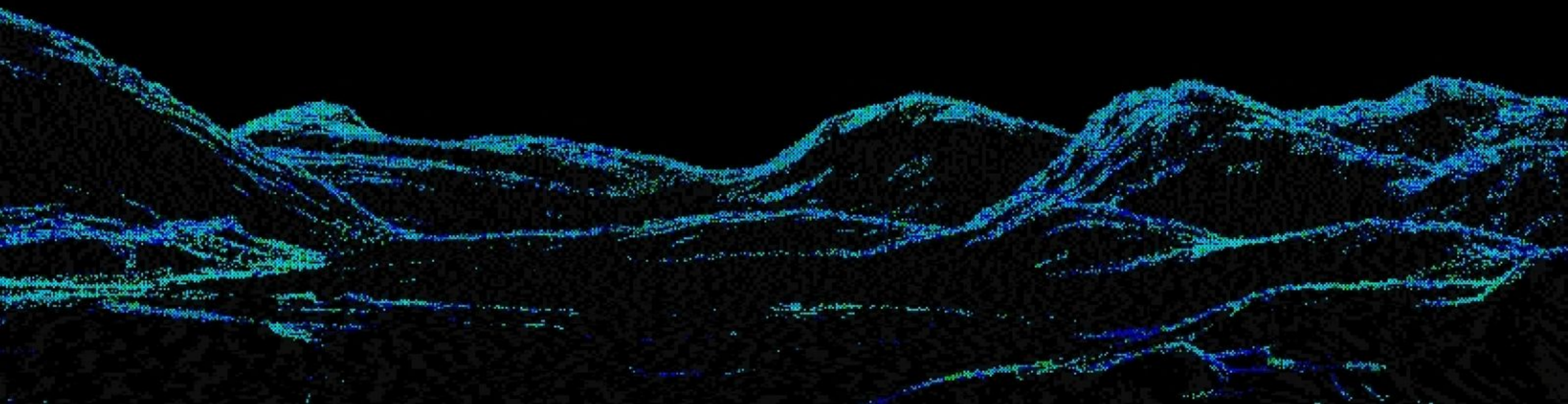
AR Interactive object

More

Media-Archeology



Objects



CELL CULTURE

Biovoodoo

Biovoodoo is a micro-human made of your tissue samples, ready to go through fire and water for your safety and curiosity!

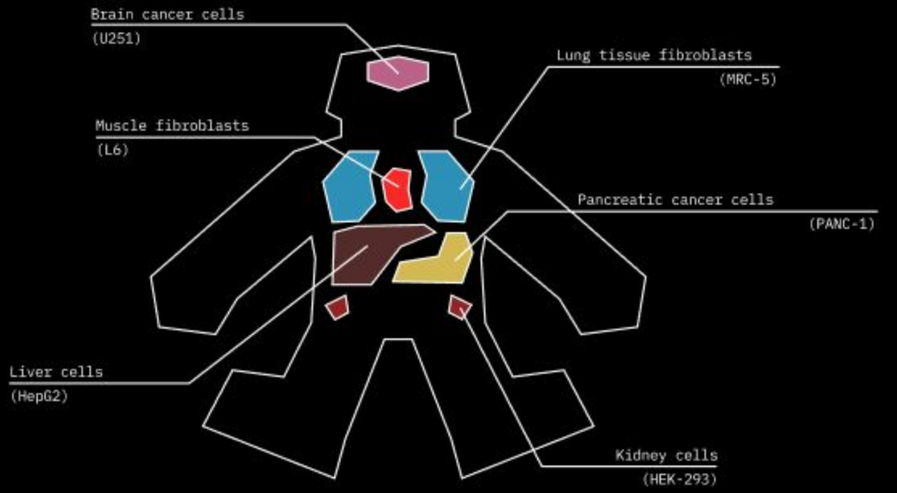
Video

Timofey Petrenko
Arkady Kukin
Anna Khodykina



Biovoodoo





Concept

We all sometimes want to do something dangerous:
Jump from the 2nd floor, eat a bar of soap, pet a wild rat, enjoy a bath in shoe polish...

Now you can test it!
Biovoodoo is a micro-human made of your tissue samples, ready to go through fire and water for your safety and curiosity!

Micro Us

Our cells are a small representation of us.
We feel strongly connected to them, yet we don't mind sacrificing them for our own good.

We created “living” people, only in a very small format. You can pity them, hate them, devalue them or love them. They are a mirror of how we treat the life inside ourselves.

BLENDER, 3D PRINTING AND ACRYLIC PAINTING

Elite

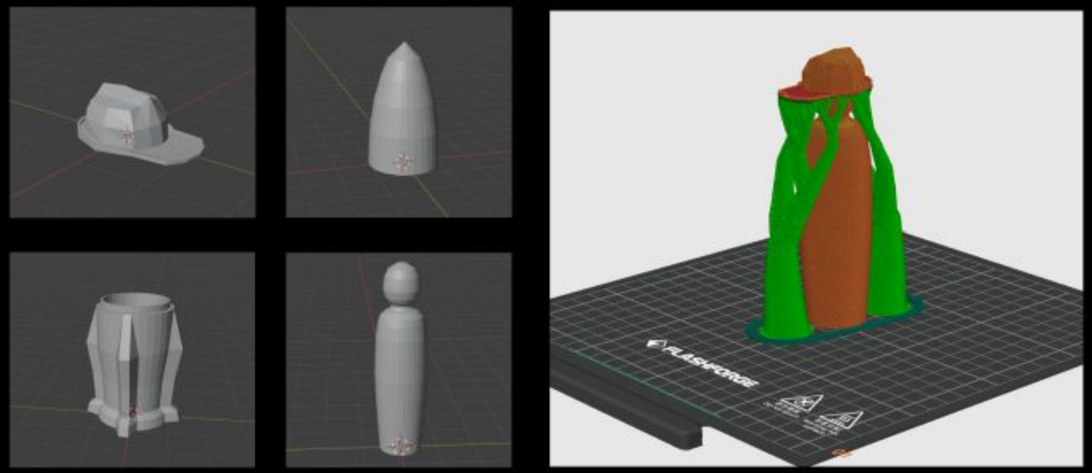


“Elite” is a matryoshka rocket that asks children and adults the question:
“Who should be sent into space?” — and teaches the basics of capitalist society.

Video

Arkady Kukin, Timofey Petrenko

Elite



Matryoshka

We decided to base it on the Soviet matryoshka rocket — a symbol of progress and dreams of a better future. And we modernized it for new realities, where it is important to teach the laws of capitalism and present two role models: the worker and the businessman — so that the child learns to choose their life path correctly.



Mismatch

But the problem is that the worker won't fit in the rocket because of his oversized hard hat. So in any case, the businessman will be the one to fly.

Practice



PRACTICE

Arcade Machines Exhibition TsFYV

Helped organize + Lecture



Arcade Machines Exhibition TsFYV



Let's play

We breathed along in The Ordinate and discussed the influence of breathing on play and consciousness.



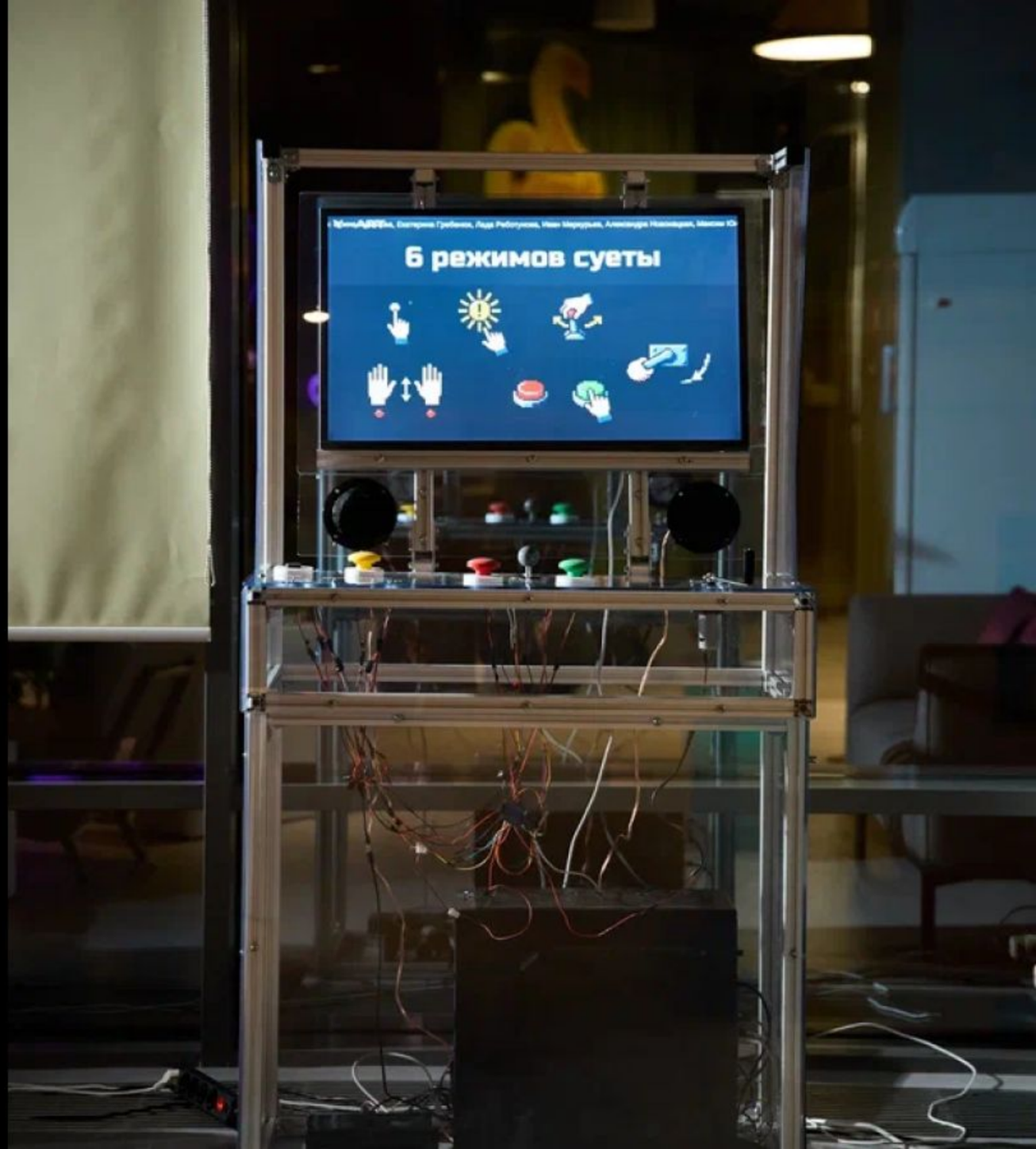
About breathing

Presented the following conclusions from The Ordinate playtests:
Focusing on breathing displaces 80% of attention; signs smaller than the full screen go unnoticed
Constant breath control creates a special state of consciousness
This state increases engagement and tolerance for failure, but people stop looking for alternative solutions

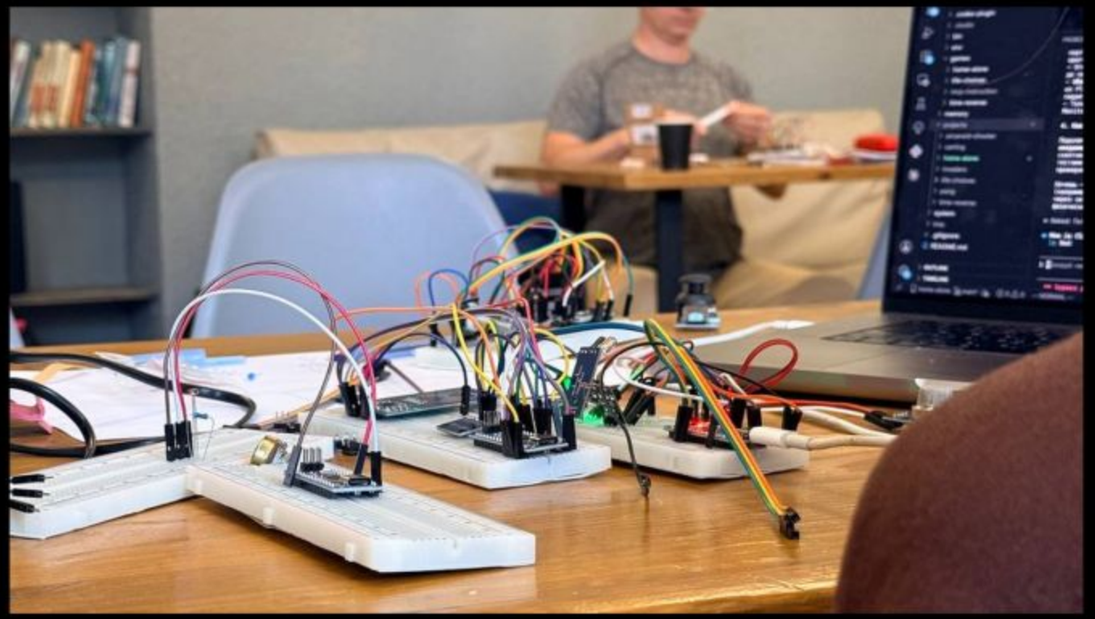
CIRCUIT DESIGN AND ARCADE MACHINES

Y.Art Residency

We studied the art of arcade machines together with the Yandex team

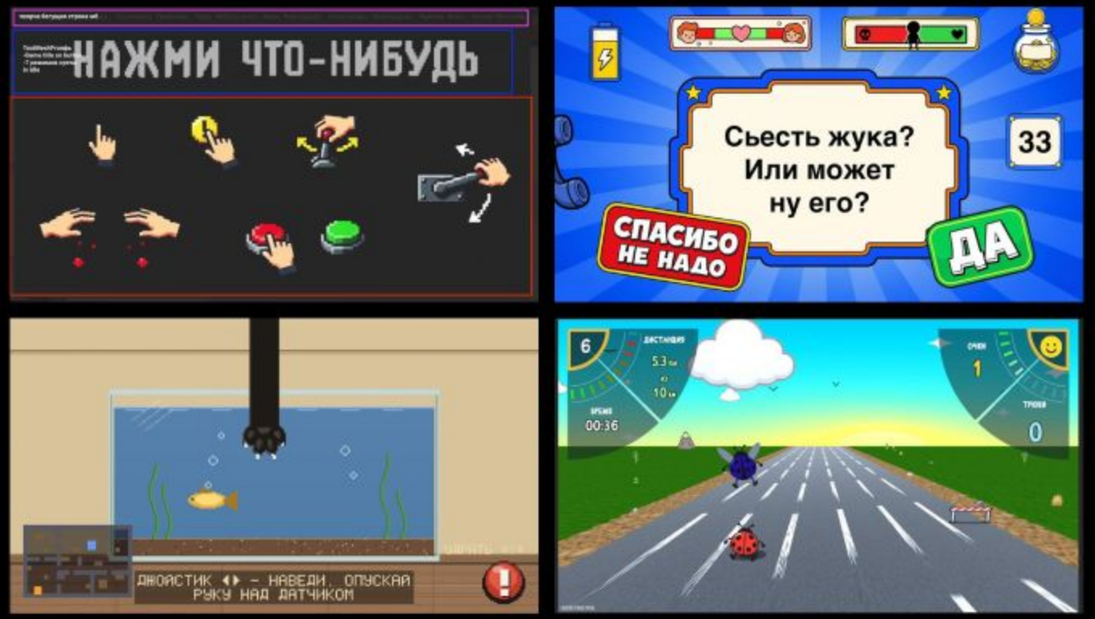


Y.Art Residency



Circuit design

We taught classes on the basics of circuit design and building your own controller for an arcade machine.

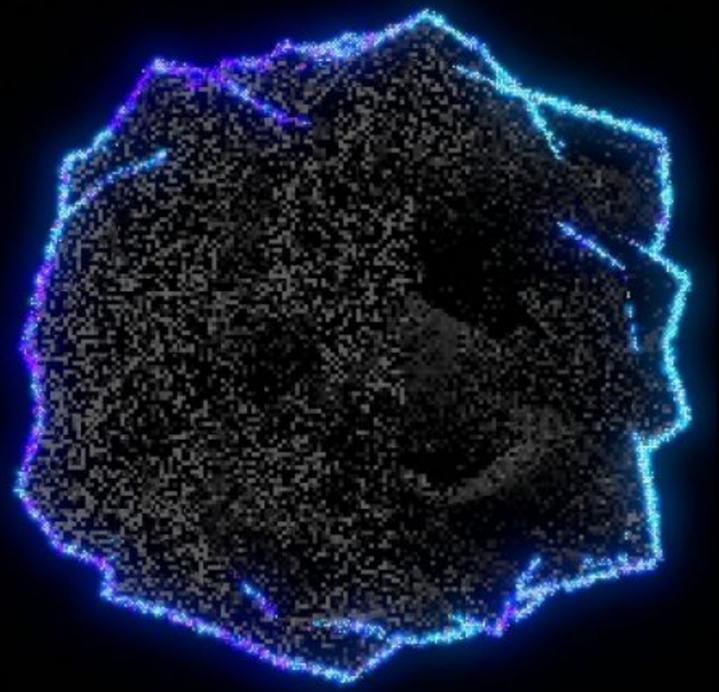


Games

Everyone came up with their own game with unusual controls — distance sensors, a dynamo, levers and buttons.

Arkady Kukin

Contacts



kukin.arkady@gmail.com

Telegram: t.me/BlackComputing